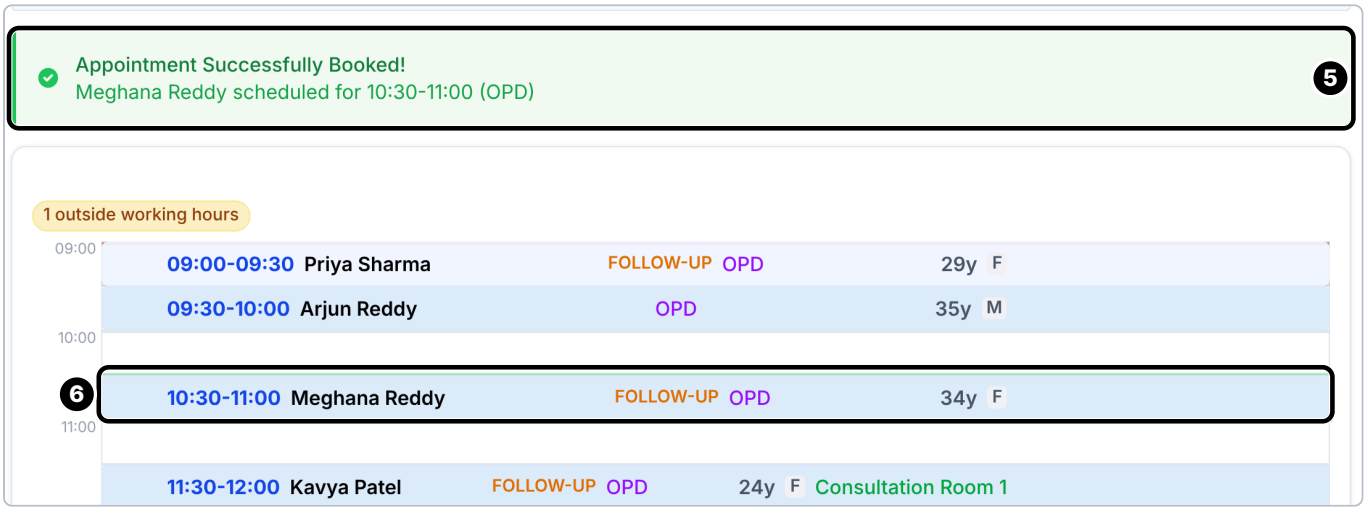
TRAINING GUIDE · NOVEMBER 2026

Booking, consulting and handing over to pharmacy: the new way

Nine short lessons that follow one patient through one morning at the OPD. Every picture is a real screen from ClinicMS, with the control you press marked by a numbered box.



For	Reception (lessons 1, 2, 3, 9) and doctors (lessons 4 to 8)	The patient	Meghana Reddy, 34, back for acne. Phone 9849012345.
Time	About 45 minutes with the practice tasks	The walk-in	Syed Arif, new to the clinic.
You need	A ClinicMS login and a training patient	The people	Riya Sharma at reception. Dr. Shravya consulting.

How to use this guide

Each lesson teaches one thing you can now do. Every lesson page has the same parts, in the same order, so you always know where to look.

PART OF THE PAGE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
The idea	How the screen works, in one sentence.
Pictures	The real screen. A black box with a number ❶ marks what to look at or press.
Do this	Three steps. The numbers in the steps match the boxes.
Words on screen	The exact text you will see, in `this type`. Look for it to know you are in the right place.
New since last lesson	What you can do now that you could not one lesson ago.
If you skip it	What goes wrong at the desk or in the consult room.

The pictures work in black and white. Nothing in this guide depends on colour.

Contents

START HERE

One morning, one patient (map) 3
What changed (quick reference) 4

PART A · RECEPTION

1 Read the doctor's day Rec 5
2 Book a returning patient Rec 6
3 Add a new patient while booking Rec 8
Practice A 9

PART B · DOCTOR

4 Open today's patient in one click Dr 10
5 Let the footer tell you what is missing Dr 11
6 Fill the prescription from a template Dr 12
7 Saving the prescription sends it Dr 13
8 Complete the visit Dr 14
Practice B 15

PART C · RECEPTION CLOSES THE LOOP

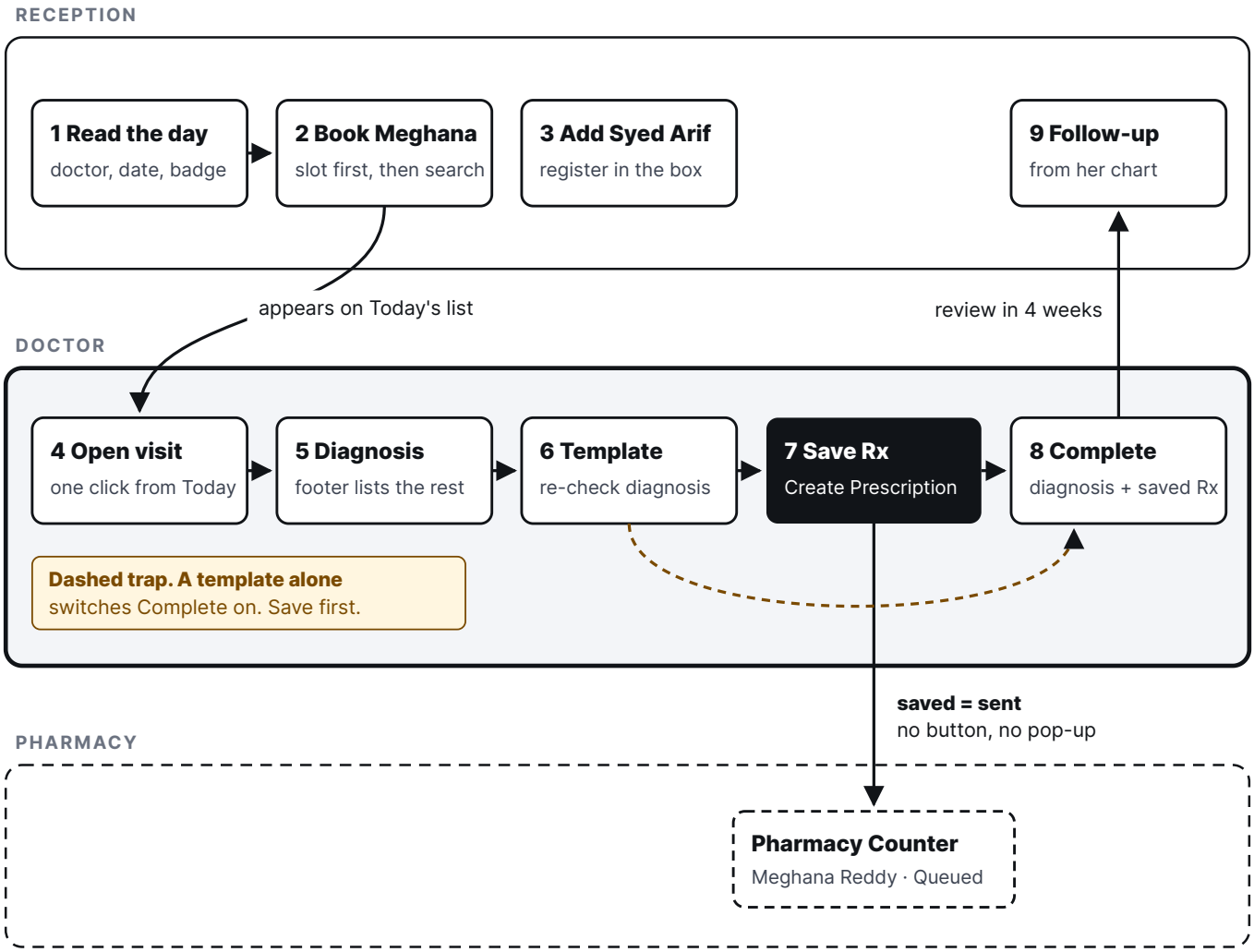
9 Book the follow-up from the chart Rec 16
Practice C and answers 17

FOR THE TRAINER

Run it in three blocks. 10 minutes on the map and the quick reference with everyone. 15 minutes on Part A with reception at their desks while doctors start Part B. 20 minutes for Part B and Part C, then go through the answers together. Use training patients only. Slow down on lesson 7. It is where a patient can leave with nothing waiting at the pharmacy.

One morning, one patient

Meghana Reddy is booked at the desk, seen by Dr. Shravya, and collects her medicines at the pharmacy counter. Nobody walks a paper slip anywhere. Each hand-off below happens because someone saved something.



READ THE MAP LIKE THIS

Solid box: reception. Grey band: the doctor's consult. Dashed box: pharmacy. The black box, lesson 7, is the only step that sends anything to another person, and it happens when the doctor presses `Create Prescription`.

THE ONE TRAP

The dashed arrow from 6 to 8 is a shortcut you must not take. A template fills the examination notes, and that alone switches `Complete Visit` on. Complete it then and the visit closes with no prescription, so the pharmacy counter has nothing for the patient. Always see `Sent to pharmacy queue` first.

What changed

Pin this page at the desk and in the consult room. Each row is one thing the screen does differently. "Before" is how ClinicMS behaved until this update. An automated walk through the live system checked every "Now" for this guide.

WHERE	BEFORE	NOW	LESSON
Booking	Choose the patient first. Clicking a free slot with no patient gave a red "Patient required" message.	Click a free slot first. `Book Appointment` opens with the cursor already in `Search patient by name or phone`.	2
New patient	Leave the calendar to register, then come back.	`Add new patient` inside the booking box. If you typed a phone number, it is already in Phone.	3
Confirm button	Below the edge of the box; you had to scroll.	`Confirm Booking` stays fixed at the bottom of the box.	2
Slots tab	Two tabs, Calendar and Slots, booking the same day two ways.	One calendar. The Slots tab is gone.	1
Evening bookings	A booking outside working hours was saved but not drawn on the day.	It is drawn. Empty rows outside hours are striped, and a badge says `1 outside working hours`.	1
Booking from a chart	Showed "Unknown Patient" and would not confirm.	`Book appointment` on the chart, pick a slot, confirm. No search.	9
Doctor's Today list	Rows were display only.	Click a row; that patient's visit opens.	4
Which doctor	The visit page picked the first doctor in the list, so visits could be saved under the wrong doctor.	Doctors get themselves. Others see `Please select a doctor to start the visit.`	4
Bell links	A link with only the appointment opened an empty setup screen.	Opens that patient with that appointment's doctor.	4
After saving Rx	A "Go to Pharmacy?" box after every save, and a Go to Pharmacy button that sent doctors to billing.	The doctor stays on the visit. `Sent to pharmacy queue` shows the prescription is already at the counter.	7
Complete Visit	Needed ticks on photos and labs too, and reopening a visit lost the ticks.	Needs a diagnosis plus a saved prescription or examination notes. Photos, labs and vitals are optional. The footer names what is missing.	5, 8
Cost of the new rule	The prescription had to be saved before Complete Visit would switch on.	Template examination notes alone switch Complete Visit on. **Save the prescription first**, or nothing reaches the pharmacy.	7

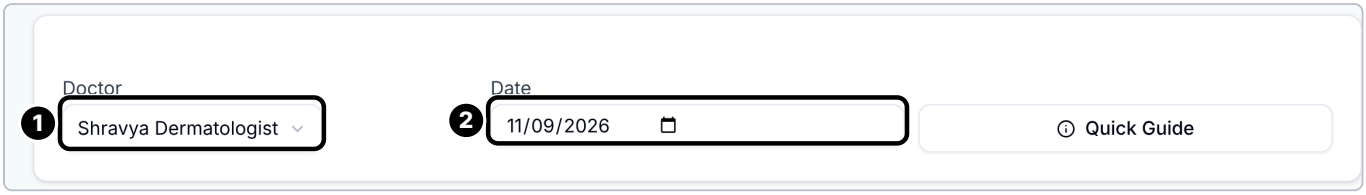
Sources. "Before" comes from the change notes for this update (commits c1acdf5, fd67075, 12ddbb3, 39d68c5, 472cda1). "Now" comes from that automated walk through the real screens, where 42 of 42 checks passed.

1

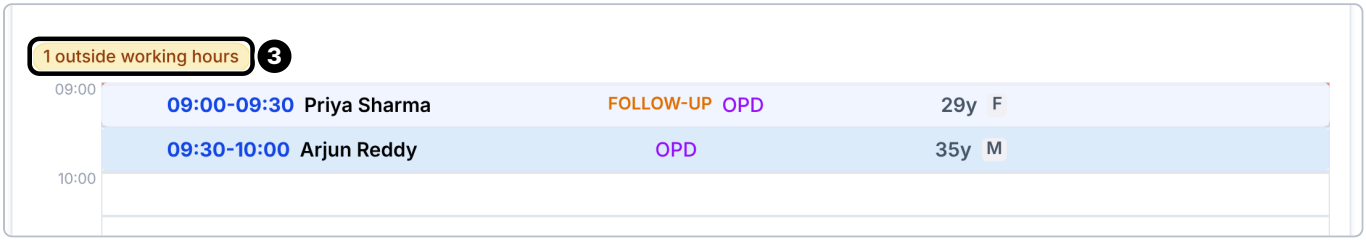
RECEPTION APPOINTMENTS

Read the doctor's day

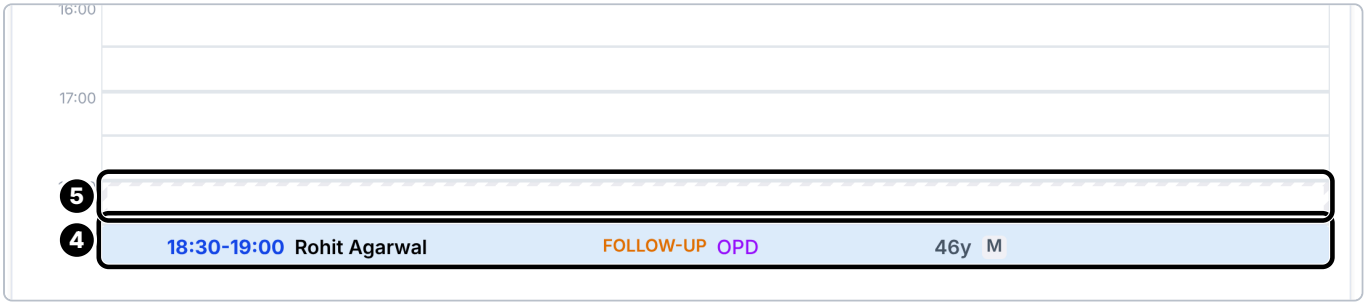
The calendar now stretches to fit every booking of the day. Anything outside the doctor's working hours sits in striped rows, and a badge at the top counts them.



Choose the doctor 1 and the date 2. There are no Calendar and Slots tabs any more.



Above the first row: the badge 3.



Further down: the striped 18:00 row 5 and the evening booking 4.

Do this

1. Open **Appointments**. Choose the **Doctor** 1 and the **Date** 2.
2. Read the badge 3. `1 outside working hours` means one booking is before opening or after closing.
3. Scroll to the striped rows 5 to find it. Today it is Rohit Agarwal at 18:30 4.

WORDS ON SCREEN

`Doctor Calendar`
`Click a free slot to book an appointment.`
`1 outside working hours`

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

One calendar instead of two tabs, and the 18:30 patient is on it. Before this update, a booking like his was saved but not drawn.

IF YOU SKIP IT

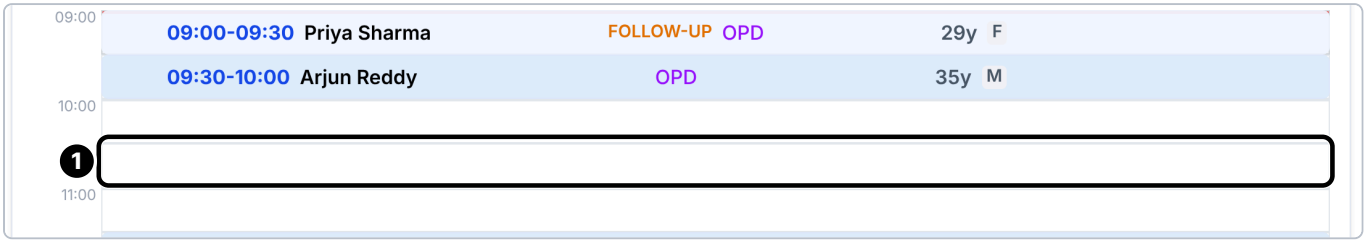
Rohit Agarwal arrives at 18:30 and nobody at the desk can find him, because everyone looked at 09:00 to 18:00 only.

2

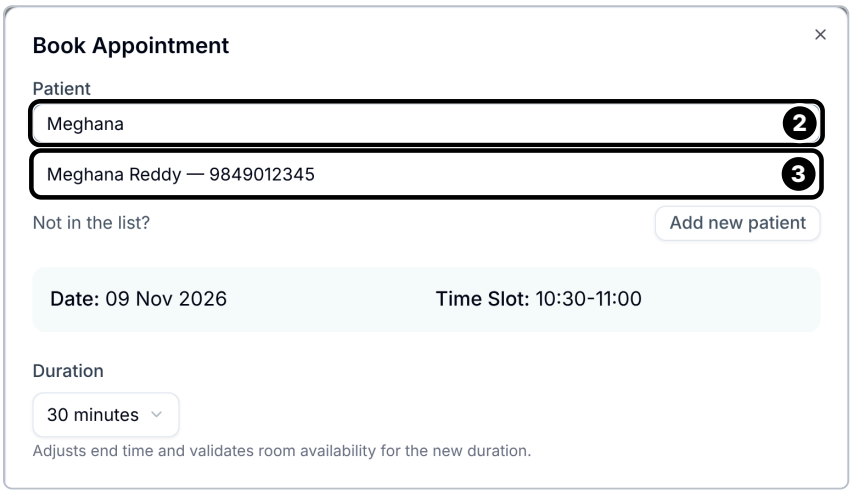
RECEPTION APPOINTMENTS

Book a returning patient

A free slot is the start button. Click it and the booking box opens with the cursor in the patient search, so you pick the time first and the person second.



Any white row is free ❶. Grey rows earlier in the day are past and cannot be clicked.



Type part of the name or the phone ❷. Click the match ❸.

Do this

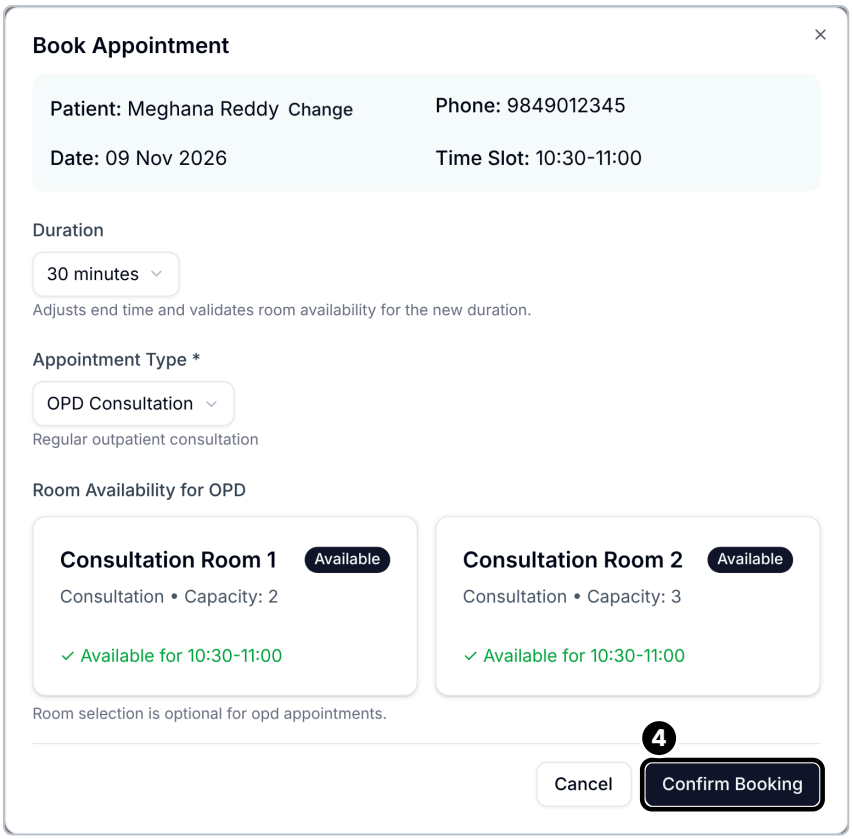
1. Click Meghana Reddy's free 10:30 row ❶. `Book Appointment` opens.
2. Just type. The cursor is already in the search ❷. Type `Meghana` or her phone, then click her name ❸.
3. Check the summary and press `Confirm Booking` ❹, fixed at the bottom of the box.

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

Lesson 1 showed you the day. Now you put Meghana Reddy into it, starting from the slot.

IF YOU SKIP IT

Look for a Patient box on the calendar before clicking a slot and you will not find one. It moved into the booking box. Always start with the slot.



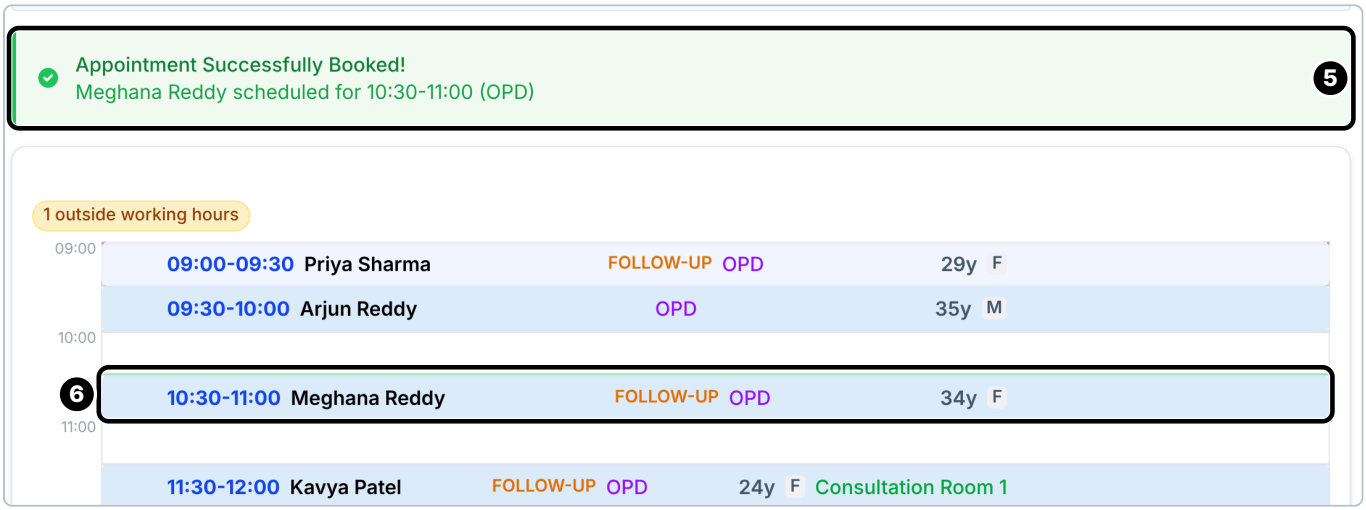
WORDS ON SCREEN

- `Search patient by name or phone`
- `Not in the list?`
- `Confirm Booking`
- `Appointment Successfully Booked!`

GOOD TO KNOW

After a booking the calendar forgets the patient. The next slot you click asks again, so you cannot book Meghana Reddy twice by accident.

After you pick her, the box shows patient, phone, date and time. Duration, type and room are already filled for an OPD visit. `Confirm Booking` 4 never scrolls away.



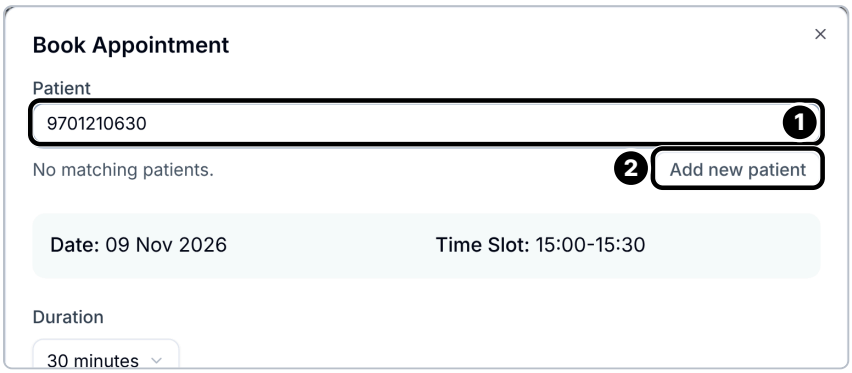
Done. A green message names the patient and time 5, and her row on the grid has a green edge 6.

3

RECEPTION APPOINTMENTS

Add a new patient while booking

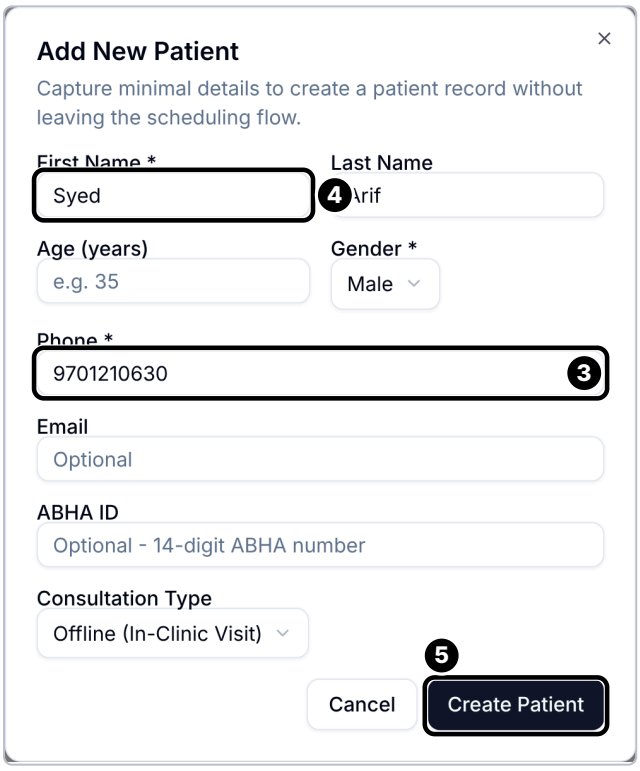
When the search finds nobody, you register the patient from inside the booking box. The phone you typed carries over, and you land back in the same booking with the new patient chosen.



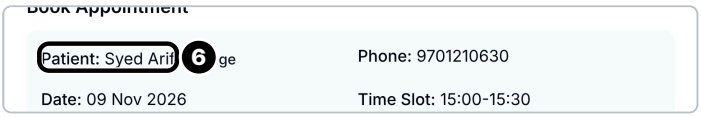
Syed Arif gives his phone 1. Nobody matches, so press `Add new patient` 2.

Do this

1. Click the free 15:00 slot. Type the phone in the search 1. When it says no match, press `Add new patient` 2.
2. Check the phone 3. Fill First Name 4, Last Name and Gender. Press `Create Patient` 5.
3. Back in the booking, check his name 6. Press `Confirm Booking`, as in lesson 2.



The phone is already in Phone 3, and First Name is empty 4.



Back in the booking box, with Syed Arif chosen 6.

WORDS ON SCREEN

`No matching patients.` `Add new patient` `Add New Patient` `Create Patient`

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

Lesson 2 needed the patient to exist already. Now a walk-in is registered and booked without leaving the calendar.

IF YOU SKIP IT

Search by name only and you can miss a patient registered under another spelling, then create a second record for the same person. Search by phone first. Add new only when the phone finds nobody.

Practice A: the reception desk

Do these on the training system, on a day your trainer gives you. Use training patients only. Answers are on the last page.

TASKS

1. Open Dr. Shravya's calendar for Monday, 9 November 2026. Write down what the badge above the grid says, and the name and time of the booking it is counting.

2. Book a returning patient, Kavya Patel, into any free afternoon slot. Start by clicking the slot. Do not touch any other field before the slot.
3. A walk-in, Lakshmi Prasanna, gives you only her phone, 9000012345. Book her into the next free slot without leaving the calendar. Before you press `Create Patient`, check which field already holds her phone.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. You click a free slot and no patient is chosen yet. What happens?
   (a) A red "Patient required" message appears. (b) The `Book Appointment` box opens with the cursor in the patient search. (c) Nothing.
2. Where do you go to see the Slots tab?

3. The badge says `2 outside working hours`. Where on the grid do you look?

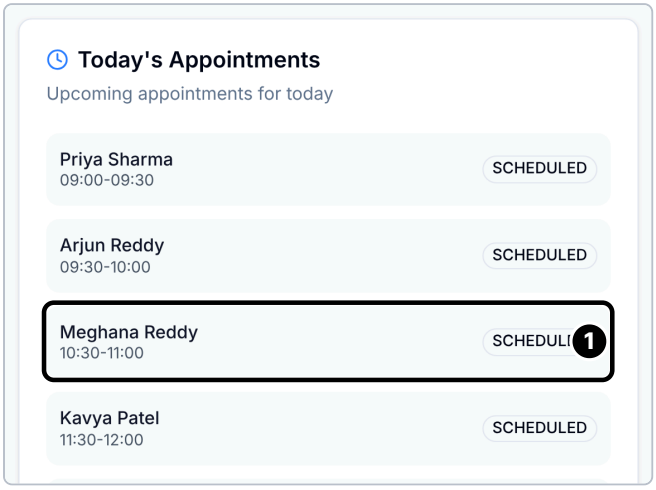
4. You just booked one patient. You click another free slot. Will it book the same patient again? Why?

4

DOCTOR DASHBOARD

Open today's patient in one click

Every row in your Today's Appointments list is a link to that patient's visit, opened under your name and tied to the appointment.



Reception's booking from lesson 2 is on your list at 10:30 (1).

Do this

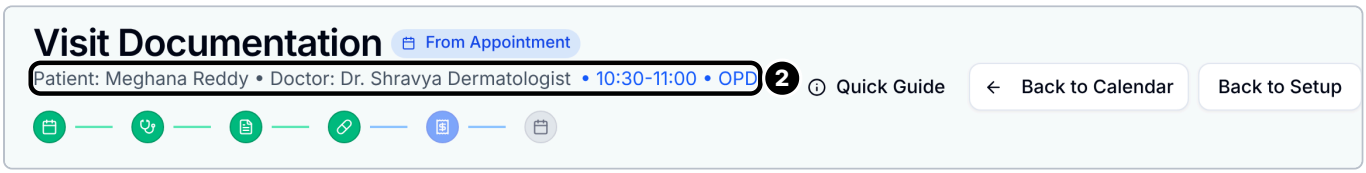
1. Open **Dashboard**. Click the patient's row in **Today's Appointments** (1).
2. Read the header (2). It must say `Patient: Meghana Reddy` and `Doctor: Dr. Shravya`. If it names another doctor, stop and tell the admin.
3. Close the **Patient Context** panel with its **×** if you want more room. You are ready to document.

WORDS ON SCREEN

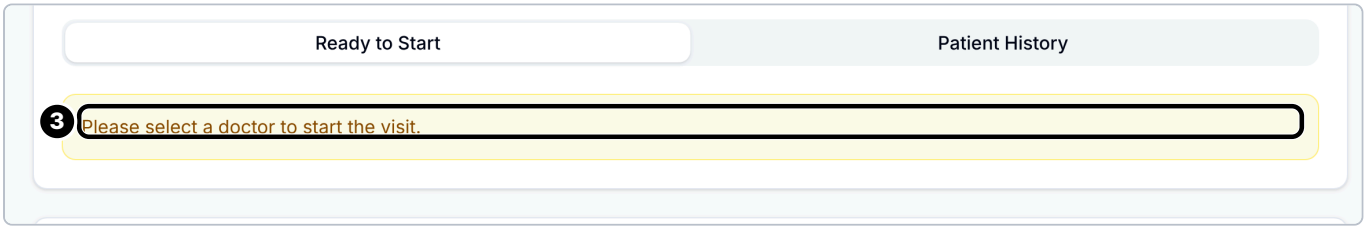
`Today's Appointments` `Visit Documentation` `From Appointment`

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

The appointment reception made is your starting point. No searching for the patient.



The visit header names the patient, you, the time and the visit type (2).



When reception or a nurse starts a visit, the screen asks which doctor (3) instead of guessing.

IF YOU SKIP IT

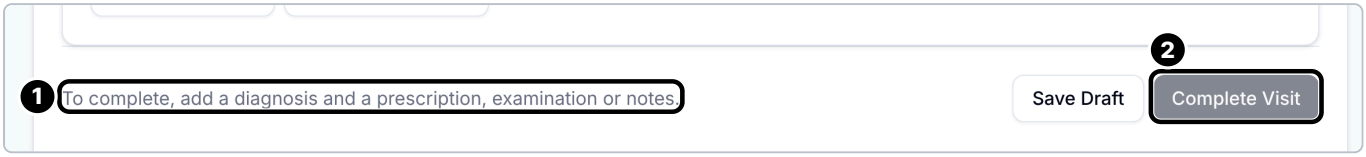
Start from the Visits page and pick the patient by hand, and you can open the wrong Meghana or a visit under the wrong doctor. The Today row and the notification bell both open the right patient with the right doctor.

5

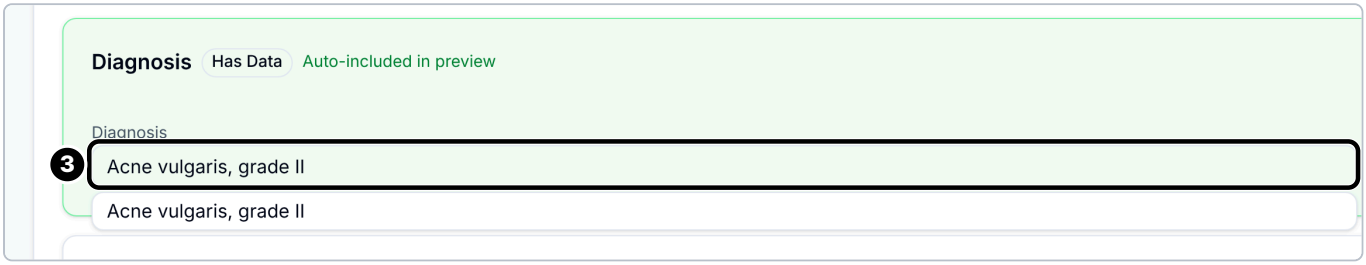
DOCTOR VISIT · PRESCRIPTION TAB

Let the footer tell you what is missing

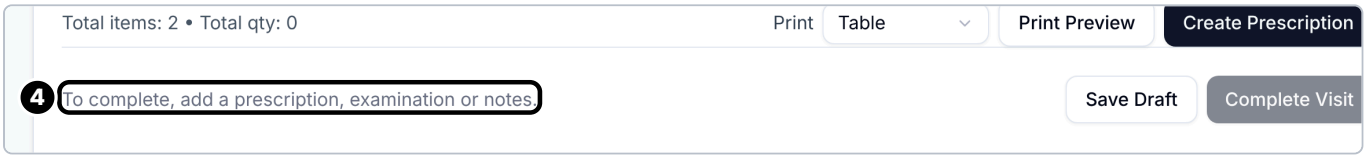
The line next to `Complete Visit` reads the record itself and names exactly what is still missing. It changes as you type. Photos, labs and vitals never appear in it, because they are optional.



An empty visit: the footer asks for two things 1, and `Complete Visit` is grey 2.



The Diagnosis field is in the **Prescription** tab 3.



With a diagnosis typed, the footer asks for one thing only 4.

Do this

1. Scroll to the bottom of the visit and read the footer 1 before you type anything.
2. Open the **Prescription** tab and type the diagnosis 3. For Meghana it is `Acne vulgaris, grade II`.
3. Read the footer again 4. Whatever it still names is your to-do list.

WORDS ON SCREEN

```
To complete, add a diagnosis and a prescription, examination or notes.
```

```
To complete, add a prescription, examination or notes.
```

IF YOU SKIP IT

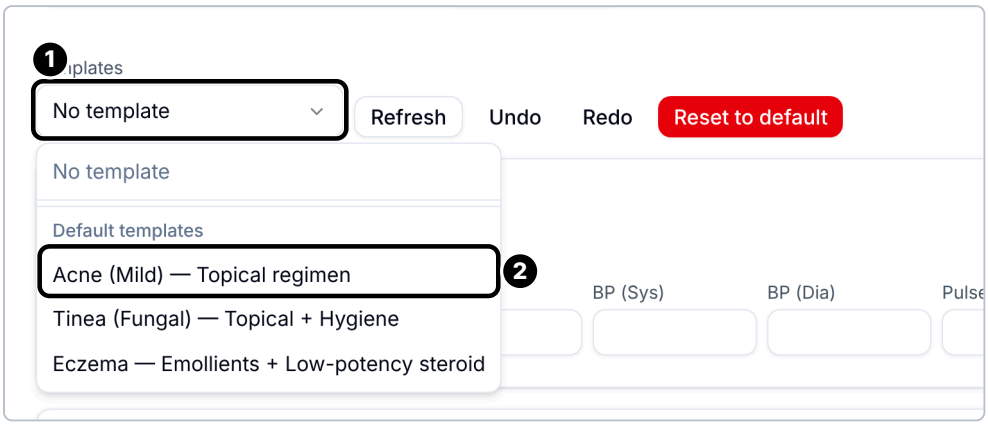
You click a grey button and nothing happens, and you start uploading photos the visit does not need. The footer already said what it needed.

6

DOCTOR VISIT · PRESCRIPTION TAB

Fill the prescription from a template

A template writes a whole prescription in one click: medicines, examination notes and its own diagnosis. It writes over what is already in those fields, so read the diagnosis again afterwards.



Open **Templates** 1 and choose one 2.

Do this

1. In the Prescription tab, open **Templates** 1, where it says `No template`.
2. Choose the template that fits 2. For Meghana it is `Acne (Mild) — Topical regimen`. Medicines and examination notes fill in.
3. Scroll back to **Diagnosis** and read it. Correct it if the template replaced yours.

SEEN ON THE TEST SYSTEM

The doctor typed `Acne vulgaris, grade II` in lesson 5. Choosing the template changed it to `Acne vulgaris (mild)`. It had to be typed again.

NOT SAVED YET

The footer goes quiet and `Complete Visit` turns on as soon as the template fills the examination notes. Nothing is saved and nothing has gone to the pharmacy. Lesson 7 is next, always.

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

Lesson 5 gave the visit a diagnosis. Now it has medicines too, ready to save.

IF YOU SKIP IT

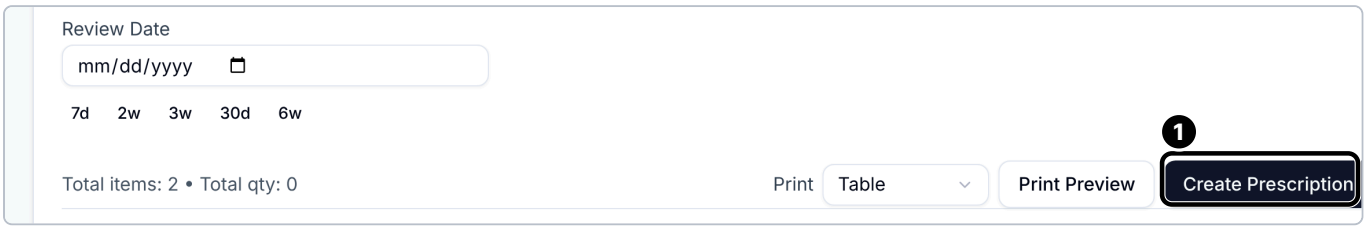
Skip the re-check and the prescription prints "Acne vulgaris (mild)" for a patient you graded II.

7

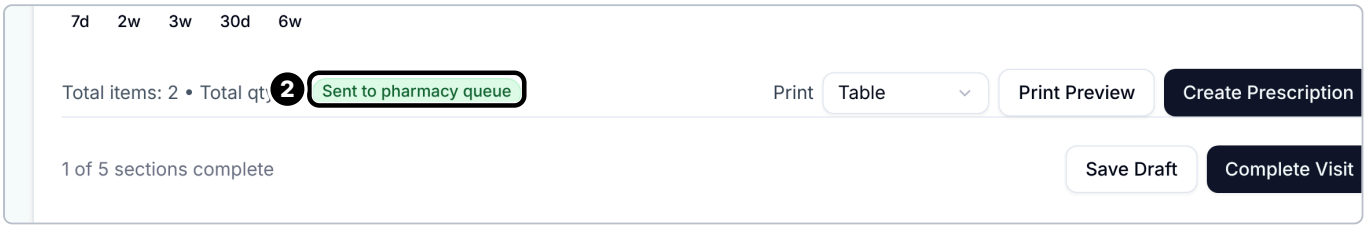
DOCTOR PHARMACY VISIT · PHARMACY COUNTER

Saving the prescription sends it

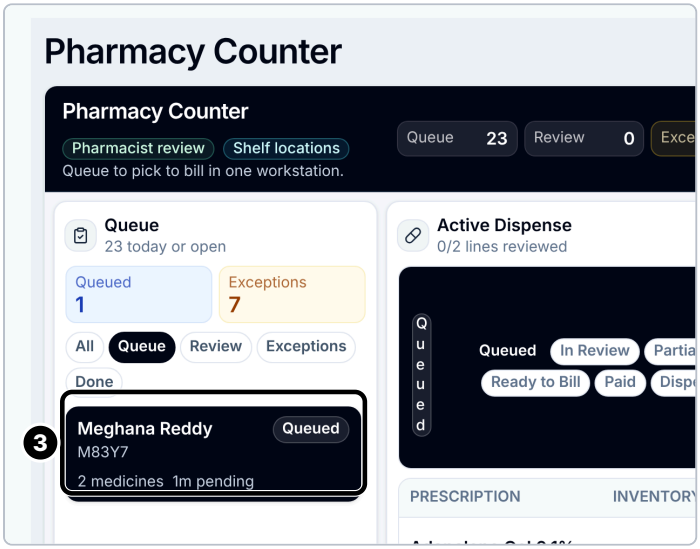
Pressing `Create Prescription` is the hand-off. The prescription goes into the pharmacy queue at that moment, and you stay on the visit. There is no "Go to Pharmacy" step any more.



The save button is at the end of the prescription 1.



After saving, the badge appears 2. No pop-up, no page change.



At the **Pharmacy Counter**, under **Queue**, it is waiting 3.

Do this

1. Scroll to the end of the prescription. Press `Create Prescription` 1.
2. Look for `Sent to pharmacy queue` 2 next to the item total. That badge is your proof.
3. Stay on the visit. Send the patient to the counter; the prescription is already there 3.

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

Until now everything stayed in the consult room. Saving puts it in front of the pharmacist.

IF YOU SKIP IT

Press `Complete Visit` without saving and the visit closes with no prescription. The patient reaches the counter and the queue has nothing for her. This was tried on the test system: a template was chosen, nothing was saved, and the visit completed with no prescription at all.

8

DOCTOR VISIT

Complete the visit

A visit can be completed once it has a diagnosis and either a saved prescription or examination notes. It checks the saved record, so a visit you reopen later is still ready.



The same visit closed and opened again. The saved diagnosis and prescription keep the footer quiet and `Complete Visit` black ❶.

Visit completed

All documentation has been marked complete.

The confirmation after pressing it.

Do this

1. Check you can see `Sent to pharmacy queue` (lesson 7).
2. Scroll to the footer. It should name nothing missing.
3. Press `Complete Visit` ❶ and wait for `Visit completed`.

WHAT YOU NO LONGER NEED

Photos, lab tests and vitals are optional. A scalp consult with no photos can be completed. Ignore the small `N of 5 sections complete` count in the footer. It still counts tabs, and it does not decide anything. After reopening this visit it read `0 of 5` while `Complete Visit` was ready.

WORDS ON SCREEN

`Complete Visit` `Visit completed` `All documentation has been marked complete.`

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

Meghana Reddy's consult is closed, with her prescription waiting at the counter.

IF YOU SKIP IT

The visit stays open in your list. At the end of the day nobody can tell which patients were seen and which are still waiting.

Practice B: the consult room

Use a training patient booked for you today. Answers are on the last page.

TASKS

1. Open your first training patient from Today's Appointments with one click. Copy the header line.
2. Before typing, scroll down and copy what the footer asks for.
3. Type a diagnosis, then choose a template. Read the diagnosis again. Did it change? To what?
4. Save the prescription. Find the badge and write its exact words. Then complete the visit.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

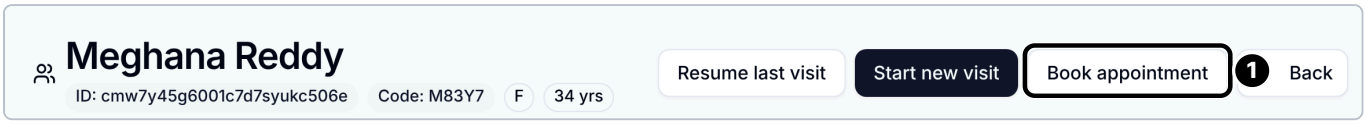
1. The footer says `To complete, add a prescription, examination or notes.` What is already in the record?
2. `Complete Visit` is black, but you cannot see `Sent to pharmacy queue`. Do you press it? What happens if you do?
3. A scalp consult: no photos, no lab tests. Can you complete the visit? What does it need?
4. After saving the prescription, where is the "Go to Pharmacy" button?

9

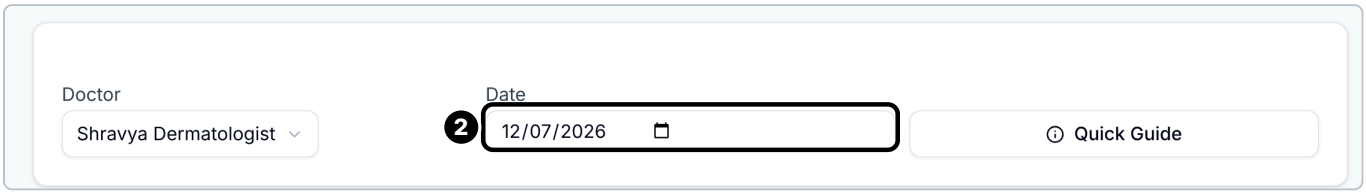
RECEPTION PATIENT CHART

Book the follow-up from the chart

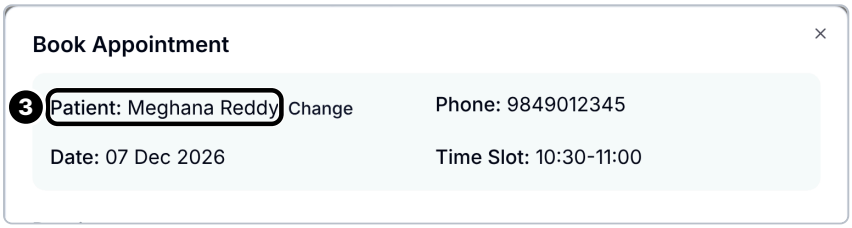
Starting from the patient's chart carries the patient into the calendar. You choose only the day and the slot, because the booking box already knows who it is for.



Meghana Reddy's chart. Press `Book appointment` 1.



The calendar opens for her. Set the review date 2.



She is already chosen 3, so there is no search box. `Confirm Booking` 4 is at the bottom, as in lesson 2.

Do this

1. Open **Patients**, find her, press `Book appointment` 1.
2. Pick the doctor and the review date 2, Monday, 7 December 2026. Click the free 10:30 slot.
3. Check her name 3. Press `Confirm Booking` 4.

NEW SINCE LAST TIME

Lesson 2 started from an empty slot. This starts from the person, which is what you have at the desk after a consult.

IF YOU SKIP IT

Before this update the chart button opened a booking for "Unknown Patient" that would not confirm. If you ever see that name, stop and report it.

Practice C, then the answers

PRACTICE C

1. Open the chart of the walk-in you added in Practice A. Book his or her review two weeks later, starting from the chart. Did you have to search for the patient?

Practice A

Task 1. `1 outside working hours`. Rohit Agarwal, 18:30 to 19:00, below the striped 18:00 row.

Task 3. Phone. A number typed in the search goes to Phone, and First Name stays empty.

Q1. (b). The red message is the old behaviour.

Q2. Nowhere. It was removed. The calendar is the only booking screen.

Q3. The striped rows: early morning above the first working hour, or evening below the last. The grid grows to include them.

Q4. No. After each booking the calendar forgets the patient, and the next slot asks again.

Practice B

Task 1. `Patient: (name) • Doctor: Dr. (you) • (time) • OPD`. If the doctor is not you, report it.

Task 2. `To complete, add a diagnosis and a prescription, examination or notes.`

Task 3. Yes, if the template has its own diagnosis. On the test system it became `Acne vulgaris (mild)`.

Task 4. `Sent to pharmacy queue`.

Q1. A diagnosis.

Q2. No. Save the prescription first. Pressing it completes the visit with no prescription, and the pharmacy gets nothing.

Q3. Yes. A diagnosis plus a saved prescription, or examination notes.

Q4. There is none. Saving sent it.

Practice C

No search. The chart carries the patient into the booking box.

ABOUT THESE PICTURES

An automated script captured these screens from a test copy of ClinicMS with test patients. The browser clock was set to Monday, 9 November 2026, 09:20 for reception and 10:35 for the doctor, so the day looks like a normal morning. To retake every picture and rerun the 42 checks, run `node docs/training/capture.cjs`, then `node docs/training/build.cjs`.